The early warning that Marwan provided to Israel on the eve of the war has preoccupied many researchers and journalists who have written tens of thousands of words on the subject. Some of them genuinely tried to expose the truth about the "failure." Others were looking for support for imaginary, even delusional, assertions.

Here is a brief summary of how things unfolded. At 22:30 on October 5, a meeting began between the source, the head of the Mossad, and the source's regular handler. After the meeting, the Mossad director phoned his bureau chief and gave him a report in code, which the bureau chief deciphered. The bureau chief then passed on the message by telephone to the prime minister's military secretary, Brigadier General Israel Lior, at 02:45, to the head of Military Intelligence, Major General Eli Zeira, at 02:55, and to the Minister of Defense's military secretary, Brigadier General Yehoshua Raviv, at 03:10. The warning read as follows:

- According to the plan, the Egyptians are going to attack toward evening. [They] know that today is a special holiday [Yom Kippur] and think they can descend before dark.
- The attack will be carried out according to the plan we are already aware of.
- In [the source's] opinion, Sadat cannot postpone the attack because of commitments he has made to other Arab heads of state, which he wants to keep down to every last detail.
- The source estimates that despite Sadat's hesitancy, the chances of an attack are 99.9 percent.
- In their [the Egyptians'] opinion, they will win, so they are very concerned about any early disclosure that could lead to outside intervention, which may deter some of their partners who may reconsider whether or not the attack is worthwhile.
- The Russians will not take part in the attack.

At 9:50 a.m. on Saturday, October 6, additional reports came in from Marwan, following his warning of the previous night. The most interesting of these was that on September 25, Sadat decided to launch the war on October 6 but did not share this decision with anyone. On September 29,